



AI TOOLS. REAL RESULTS.

THE ACCOUNTANT'S AI TOOLKIT

5 practical ways to save hours every week, stop staring at a blank page, and let AI handle the admin so you can focus on clients.

A free guide from **Apto Tools**



AI won't replace accountants.

Accountants using AI will replace those who don't.

This guide pulls together five practical angles on using AI in an accounting practice — what it can do for you today, the exact prompts to get started, and how small firms are using a few extra hours a week to serve more clients and deliver better advice. No tech skills required.

01 5 Ways AI Saves Accountants Hours Every Week

The five jobs to hand to AI first

02 Stop Starting From a Blank Page

Ready-to-use prompts for the documents you write most

03 The Accountant's AI Assistant

What a 24/7 assistant can actually draft for you

04 What Could You Do With 5 Extra Hours a Week?

Turning saved admin time into client value

05 Don't Fear AI — Learn To Use It

Why Accountant + AI beats Accountant vs AI



SECTION 01

5 Ways AI Saves Accountants Hours Every Week

Most firms lose hours every week to work that AI can now do in seconds. Here are the five highest-impact places to start.

- **Draft client emails** — turn a rough note into a polished, on-brand email in seconds, ready for you to review and send.
- **Explain tax rules simply** — translate dense HMRC/legislative language into plain English your client will actually understand.
- **Summarise documents** — condense long reports, statements, or correspondence into a short brief before a meeting.
- **Create reports** — generate a first draft of a management report or client update from your own bullet points and figures.
- **Answer client questions faster** — get an instant first-pass answer to common client questions, which you check and personalise.

PROMPT YOU CAN COPY — Client email

"Write a short, friendly email to a client explaining that their Self Assessment deadline is approaching, that I need their bank interest and dividend figures, and that they should reply by [date]. Keep it under 120 words."

Rule of thumb: AI drafts, you decide. Every output above still needs your review — the time saving comes from never starting from a blank page.



SECTION 02

Stop Starting From a Blank Page

The blank page is where most admin time disappears. Give AI a rough brief and it can produce a working first draft of any of the documents below in seconds — then it's just editing, not writing.

- **Client emails** — Routine updates, chasers, and responses to common questions.
- **Tax explanations** — Plain-English breakdowns of rules, thresholds, and deadlines.
- **Engagement letters** — A first-draft structure you tailor to the specific engagement.
- **Reminder messages** — Friendly nudges for missing information or upcoming deadlines.
- **Meeting summaries** — A clean written record of decisions and next steps from your notes.

PROMPT YOU CAN COPY — Meeting summary

"Here are my rough notes from a client meeting: [paste notes]. Turn these into a short, clear summary with three sections: Key Points Discussed, Decisions Made, and Next Steps (with owner and due date for each)."

PROMPT YOU CAN COPY — Reminder message

"Write a polite but firm reminder to a client who hasn't sent their P11D information, due in 5 days. Reference the deadline and the consequence of late submission, and keep the tone professional, not pushy."



SECTION 03

The Accountant's AI Assistant

Think of AI as a junior team member who is available 24/7, never gets tired, and never forgets a format you've asked for before. It won't replace your judgement — but it will take the first draft off your plate.

- **Reports** — First drafts of management accounts commentary, variance explanations, and year-end summaries.
- **Emails** — On-brand client and internal correspondence, drafted from a one-line instruction.
- **Checklists** — Onboarding checklists, year-end checklists, and compliance checklists tailored to a client type.
- **Client guides** — Simple explainer documents you can reuse across your client base.

PROMPT YOU CAN COPY — Client onboarding checklist

"Create an onboarding checklist for a new limited company client, covering the information, documents, and access I need to gather before I can start work, grouped under clear headings."

Small firms, big leverage. You don't need an IT department or a big budget — a browser and a good prompt is enough to start saving time and improving client service today.



SECTION 04

What Could You Do With 5 Extra Hours a Week?

Let AI handle the repetitive work, and put the time back into the parts of the job only you can do: advising clients and growing the practice.

Writing emails & documents Explaining tax rules Summarising reports Data analysis Client communications	Proactive client check-ins Business advisory conversations Spotting planning opportunities Winning new clients Developing the team

PROMPT YOU CAN COPY — Turning saved time into advice

"Based on this client's last two years of management accounts [paste summary figures], identify three trends worth raising with them and draft a short, friendly note flagging each one and suggesting a call to discuss."

Stop doing. Start achieving. Reclaiming even five hours a week is a full extra working day, every month, that can go straight back into client relationships.



SECTION 05

Don't Fear AI. Learn To Use It.

The future isn't Accountant vs AI. It's Accountant + AI — and that combination is the one winning firms are backing.

- **Save time** — on the repetitive writing and admin tasks that eat into billable hours.
- **Serve more clients** — without adding headcount, by clearing the admin bottleneck.
- **Deliver better advice** — because the time you save goes back into thinking, not typing.
- **Reduce stress** — by removing the blank-page problem from your daily workload.
- **Grow your business** — as capacity frees up for higher-value advisory work.

Getting started doesn't require a big leap. Pick one task from this guide — a client email, a checklist, a meeting summary — and use one of the prompts above this week. Once it becomes a habit, add the next one.

The firms embracing AI today are the ones leading tomorrow. Stay ahead. Start now.





READY TO PUT THIS INTO PRACTICE?

Explore AI Tools for Accountants

Apto Tools brings together practical, no-jargon AI tools and prompt packs built specifically for accountants and small firms — no tech skills required.

Discover how at **Apto Tools**

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